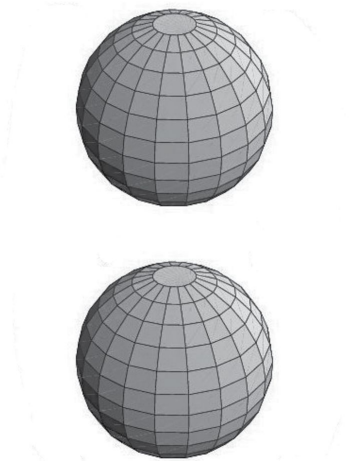


Figure 3.12 A 3-sphere can be represented as two balls joined together.

There is one more observation which I would like to make about Einstein's 3-sphere. However incredible it might seem, the same idea had already been conceived by another genius, from an entirely different cultural universe: Dante Alighieri, Italy's greatest poet. In the *Paradiso*, the third part of his major poem, the *Commedia*, Dante offers a grandiose vision of the medieval world, calqued on the world of Aristotle, with the spherical Earth at its centre, surrounded by the celestial spheres (figure 3.13).

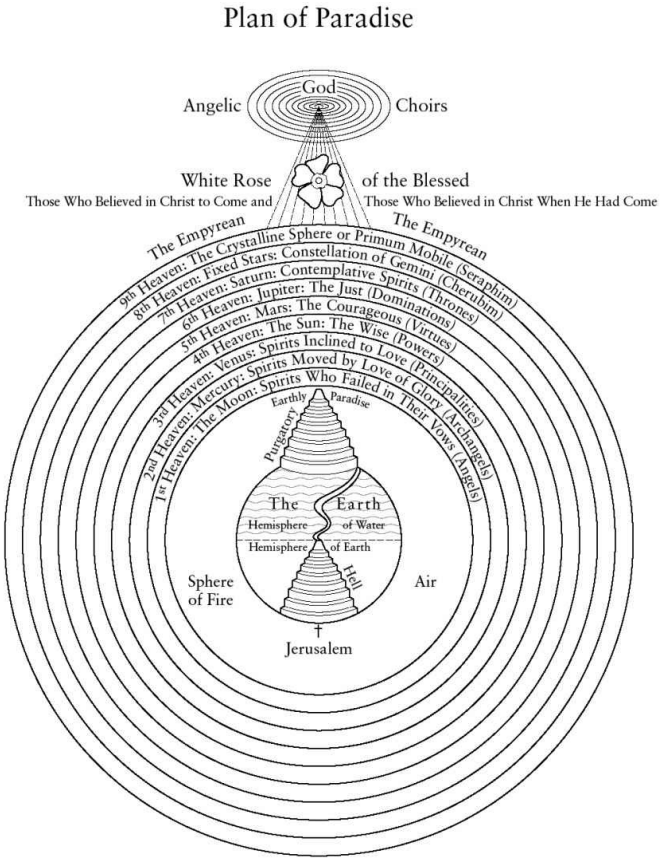


Figure 3.13 Traditional representation of Dante's universe.